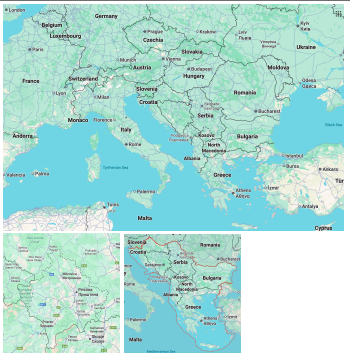


Kosovo/Kocobo/Kosovë

The context of a conflict
H. Sivak

Balkans in context

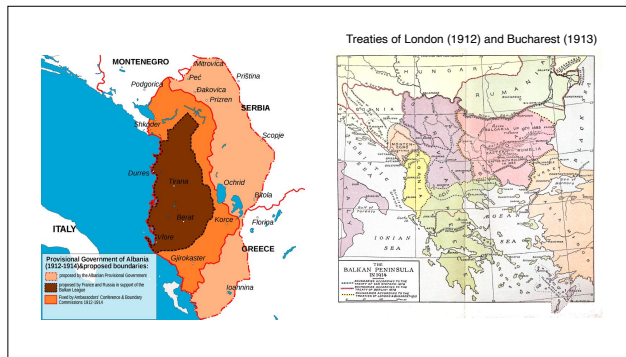
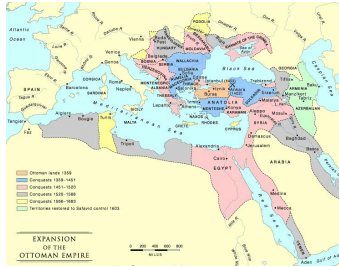
- 'Balkan' as endless, petty division.
- Kosovo as a *de facto* state:
 - Declared independence 2008.
 - Recognized by 108 countries & three non-UN countries.
- Major non recognition:
 - Russia
 - China
 - India
 - Brazil
 - Serbia

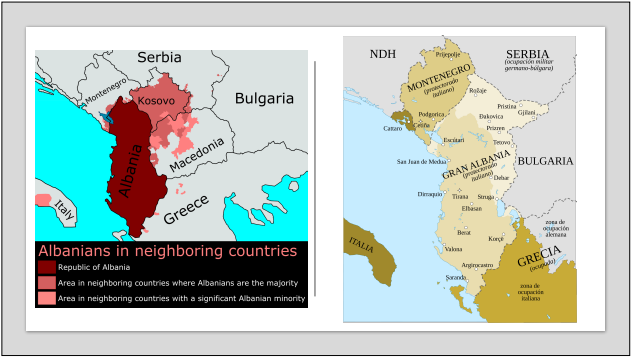
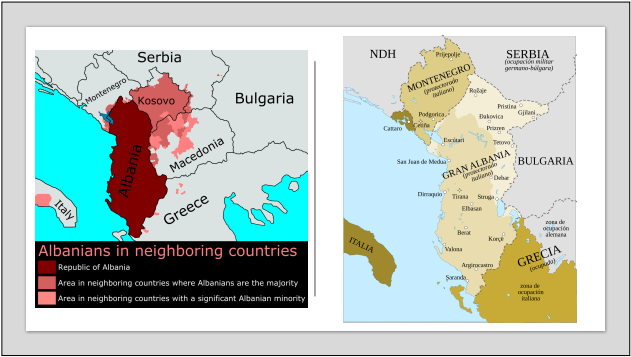
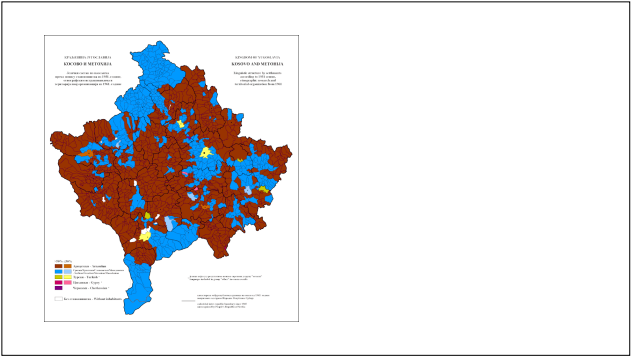


General History

The Ottoman Empire and the Vilayet system

- The 'people of the book'.
- Multicultural cities (Thessaloniki/ Salonica).
- Little in the way of 'state-building' or 'nation-building'.
- Vilayet system facilitates legal and economic governance but limited modern state apparatus.





Yugoslavia



Yugoslavia breaks up in Kosovo

- 'Kosovo, or Kosova, could be either Serbian or Albanian, but not both'.
 - The myth of 1389: growth of a Serbian empire (1331-1389) & memorialization of Miloš Obilić.
- 1981: 77.5 per cent of the Kosovo population was Albanian (1,226,736) and only 13.2 per cent Serb (210,000).
 - Economic failure + a young population in Kosovo seeking something other than Yugoslav socialism; 1981 demonstrations.
- 1989: Loss of autonomy for Kosovo; Albanization of Kosovo's communist party.
- By 1991 the Albanian nationalist movement became a mirror image of the nationalist projects raging throughout the former Yugoslavia.

'Death to fascism, freedom to the people'

